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# CHAPTER 2

## Expansion of British Power in India (Part 5)

### British Paramountcy through Administrative Policies

#### Introduction

After conquering many Indian states through wars, the British expanded their empire by using **administrative and diplomatic policies**.

The three most important policies were:

- **Ring-Fence Policy**
- **Subsidiary Alliance**
- **Doctrine of Lapse**

These policies helped the British control India without fighting every state. They are among the **most frequently asked topics** in Punjab Police, PSSSB, PCS, SSC and UPSC examinations.

#### British Paramountcy

##### What was it?

British Paramountcy means the British became the **supreme authority** over Indian princely states.

##### Important Exam Facts

- The Company expanded its empire by:
  - **War (Annexation by Conquest)**
  - **Diplomacy and Administrative Policies**
- The three major policies were:
  - **Ring-Fence Policy**
  - **Subsidiary Alliance**
  - **Doctrine of Lapse**

# Ring-Fence Policy

## What was it?

The British protected neighbouring states to protect their own territories.

## Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **Warren Hastings**.
- Mainly used for the protection of British frontiers.
- The Company agreed to defend allied states.
- The allied ruler had to pay the expenses of the British army.
- British officers organised and commanded the army stationed in those states.

# Subsidiary Alliance

## What was it?

An Indian ruler accepted a permanent British army inside his state and lost control over foreign affairs.

## Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **Lord Wellesley**.
- It was an extension of the **Ring-Fence Policy**.
- A permanent British force was stationed in the allied state.
- The ruler had to pay **subsidy** for maintaining the British army.
- A **British Resident** was appointed in the ruler's court.
- The ruler could not:
  - Employ any European without British permission.
  - Declare war.
  - Sign treaties with other Indian rulers without British approval.
- In return, the British promised protection from external enemies and followed a policy of **non-interference** in internal matters.

# States under Subsidiary Alliance

| State                              | Year        |
|------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Awadh</b> (First State)         | 1765        |
| Hyderabad                          | 1798 & 1800 |
| Mysore                             | 1799        |
| Tanjore                            | 1799        |
| Awadh (New Agreement)              | 1801        |
| Peshwa                             | 1801        |
| Bhonsle of Berar                   | 1803        |
| Sindhia                            | 1804        |
| Jodhpur                            | 1818        |
| Jaipur                             | 1818        |
| Macheri                            | 1818        |
| Bundi                              | 1818        |
| Bharatpur                          | 1818        |
| <b>Holkar</b> (Last Maratha State) | 1818        |

## Doctrine of Lapse

### What was it?

If a ruler died without a **natural male heir**, the British could annex the state.

### Important Exam Facts

- Introduced by **Lord Dalhousie**.
- The adopted son could inherit **private property**, but not the kingdom.
- The British decided whether the state would continue or be annexed.
- Many states were annexed because rulers died without a natural male heir.
- **Awadh** was annexed separately on the ground of **misgovernment**, not under the Doctrine of Lapse.

## States Annexed under Doctrine of Lapse

| State             | Year |
|-------------------|------|
| <b>Satara</b>     | 1848 |
| <b>Sambhalpur</b> | 1849 |
| <b>Baghat</b>     | 1850 |

|        |      |
|--------|------|
| Jhansi | 1854 |
| Nagpur | 1854 |

# Awadh

## Special Exam Fact

- **Awadh was annexed in 1856.**
- Reason: **Misgovernment.**
- **It was not annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse.**

## Important Personalities

| Personality     | Importance                                             |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Warren Hastings | Introduced the Ring-Fence Policy.                      |
| Lord Wellesley  | Introduced the Subsidiary Alliance.                    |
| Lord Dalhousie  | Introduced the Doctrine of Lapse.                      |
| Nawab of Awadh  | First ruler connected with the Subsidiary Alliance.    |
| Wajid Ali Shah  | Nawab of Awadh removed on the ground of misgovernment. |

## Important Policies

| Policy              | Importance                                                                |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ring-Fence Policy   | British defended neighbouring states to secure their own borders.         |
| Subsidiary Alliance | Indian rulers accepted British military protection and political control. |
| Doctrine of Lapse   | States without a natural male heir could be annexed by the British.       |

## Important Years

| Year | Event                                                               |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1765 | Awadh accepted the Subsidiary Alliance (first state in the source). |
| 1798 | Hyderabad accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.                         |
| 1799 | Mysore and Tanjore accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.                |
| 1801 | Awadh and Peshwa accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.                  |
| 1803 | Bhonsle accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.                           |
| 1804 | Sindhia accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.                           |
| 1818 | Rajput States and Holkar accepted the Subsidiary Alliance.          |

|      |                                               |
|------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1848 | Satara annexed.                               |
| 1849 | Sambhalpur annexed.                           |
| 1850 | Baghat annexed.                               |
| 1854 | Jhansi and Nagpur annexed.                    |
| 1856 | Awadh annexed on the ground of misgovernment. |

## Frequently Confused Facts

| Question                                     | Correct Answer  |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Ring-Fence Policy                            | Warren Hastings |
| Subsidiary Alliance                          | Lord Wellesley  |
| Doctrine of Lapse                            | Lord Dalhousie  |
| First State under Subsidiary Alliance        | Awadh           |
| Last Maratha State under Subsidiary Alliance | Holkar          |
| State annexed due to misgovernment           | Awadh           |
| State famous for Rani Lakshmibai             | Jhansi          |
| First state annexed under Doctrine of Lapse  | Satara          |

## Previous Year Exam Focus

- British Paramountcy.
- Ring-Fence Policy.
- Warren Hastings.
- Subsidiary Alliance.
- Lord Wellesley.
- British Resident.
- Restrictions under the Subsidiary Alliance.
- First state under the Subsidiary Alliance.
- Doctrine of Lapse.
- Lord Dalhousie.
- Satara.
- Jhansi.
- Nagpur.
- Awadh.
- Wajid Ali Shah.

# Expected MCQ Areas

- Three administrative policies.
- Introducers of each policy.
- Subsidiary Alliance conditions.
- British Resident.
- First and last states under the Subsidiary Alliance.
- Doctrine of Lapse.
- States annexed under Doctrine of Lapse.
- Awadh annexation.
- Wajid Ali Shah.
- Difference between Doctrine of Lapse and Misgovernment.

# Memory Tricks

- **Hastings = Hedge (Ring around the Border)**
- **Wellesley = War Without Fighting (Subsidiary Alliance)**
- **Dalhousie = Dies without Son → Doctrine**
- **Awadh = Administration Failed → Misgovernment**
- **SHJN = Satara → Sambhalpur → Jhansi → Nagpur**

# Quick Revision (2 Minutes)

- Paramountcy
- Ring-Fence
- Warren Hastings
- Frontier Defence
- Subsidiary Alliance
- Lord Wellesley
- British Resident

- Subsidy
- No Foreign Relations
- No European Employment
- Doctrine of Lapse
- Lord Dalhousie
- Satara
- Sambhalpur
- Baghat
- Jhansi
- Nagpur
- Awadh
- Misgovernment
- Wajid Ali Shah
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